

How to Add Your Activity to the Repo

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You wrote your activity in Google Docs (or similar). Here's how to get it into TADA! correctly.

The short version

1. Export your doc as Markdown.
2. Save it in the right folder, correctly numbered.
3. Add a frontmatter block at the top (see below) — **this is the important part.**
4. Push, or open a Pull Request.
5. A bot opens a PR that wires in your navigation links and index entry automatically. Someone merges it.

That's it for beginner and intermediate activities. Advanced has one extra manual step — see the note at the bottom.

1. Export your doc as Markdown

In Google Docs: **File** → **Download** → **Markdown (.md)**

Before uploading, skim the exported file for these — Google's export does this almost every time:

- Stray backslashes before punctuation, like `Choose your adventure\!` — delete them.
- Heading levels that don't match the site (`#` for the activity title, `##` for major sections, `###` for numbered steps).

2. Name the file and place it

Files are numbered per category, each restarting at 1:

```
adventure_map/adventure_map_activities/  
  beginner/      → 5_beginner.md, 6_beginner.md, ...  
  intermediate/  → 5_intermediate.md, ...  
  advanced/      → 10_advanced.md, ...
```

Use the next open number in your category.

3. Add the frontmatter block

This is a small metadata header at the very top of the file, between two --- lines. It's invisible on the actual page — it's what the automation reads to build your navigation links and index entry for you. Fill in all five fields:

```
---
title: "Activity 5, Beginner - Your Activity Name"
description: Tactile Art & Design Adventures by the Center for Assistive Technology Training
order: 5
nav_title: "Activity 5: Your Activity Name"
index_title: "Your Activity Name"
summary: "One or two sentences describing what students do in this activity."
goals: "What students will learn or practice."
---
```

What each field does:

Field	What it controls
order	Where your activity sits in the sequence
nav_title	Text in the Previous/Next footer link
index_title	Text in the Adventure Map list ("Activity 5:" prefix is added automatically)
summary	One-line description under your link in the Adventure Map
goals	The Goals: line under that

Everything below the frontmatter — your # title, Setup section, numbered steps — stays exactly like any other activity file already looks.

4. Push it

- Write access: commit and push your new file to **main**.
- No write access: open a Pull Request with it.

You do **not** need to manually edit the footer links or 04_ADVENTURE_MAP.md yourself — an automation handles that next.

5. What happens after you push

A GitHub Action notices your new file, and:

- Rewrites the Previous/Next footer on your file *and* on the activity before it, so they link to each other.
- Adds your activity’s entry into `04_ADVENTURE_MAP.md` automatically, using the `summary/goals/index_title` you wrote.
- Opens a **Pull Request** with those changes — it never pushes straight to `main`. Someone reviews and merges, same as any other change.

One thing this doesn’t do for you: if there’s a `### Activity [N]: Coming Soon` placeholder line sitting in `04_ADVENTURE_MAP.md`, delete that line yourself — the automation won’t touch it since it can’t tell it’s meant to be replaced.

Advanced tier: one extra manual step

Advanced activities get their footer links automated the same way. But the Advanced section of `04_ADVENTURE_MAP.md` mixes real activities with hand-written section headers (like “Section A: Making 2D Shapes in OpenSCAD”) that don’t correspond to any file — so that index section is never auto-generated. If you’re adding an advanced activity, add its line to `04_ADVENTURE_MAP.md` yourself, in the same format as the ones already there.

Before you push, check:

- ☐ File placed in the right tier folder, correctly numbered
- ☐ Frontmatter has `order`, `nav_title`, `index_title`, `summary`, and `goals` filled in
- ☐ No stray backslashes or mismatched heading levels left from the Google Docs export
- ☐ Any images have real descriptive alt text (not just a caption)
- ☐ No emojis

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